

Wholesale archetype development

UK Fabric

June 2026

Confirmation of deliverables, scope and purpose

Workstream 3: Customer needs and requirements (20-30 slides)

Purpose: Define who BT should target, what they need from NaaS and what this means for UK Fabric proposition design, digital experience and sales approach

- **Customer segmentation overview:** Common trends across BT customer segments (Enterprise, Wholesale)
- **Priority NaaS customer archetypes:** Behavioural archetype profiles covering organisation type, verticals, network estate, digital maturity and operating model
- **Customer pain points and unmet needs:** Key friction points across connectivity services
- **NaaS needs, wants and expectations:** What customers value most from NaaS across the 7 attributes (& relative importance by archetype)
- **Commercial and experience requirements:** Preferred commercial models and guardrails; appetite for self-service (portal vs API vs assisted support expectations)
- **Implications for UK Fabric:** What findings mean for proposition design, digital experience, sales approach and migration support

Primary research progress overview

Segment A: Enterprise interviews

Completed	Scheduled	To schedule
9	0	1

Enterprise survey to be launched this week

Segment B: Wholesale interviews

Completed	Scheduled	To schedule
6	2	2

Wholesale customers derive value from connectivity differently to enterprises, so require a separate approach to archetype design

	Enterprise	Wholesale
Relationship to UK Fabric	Consumes UK Fabric as the end-user	Uses UK Fabric to serve, support or sell to its own customers
What NaaS needs are driven by	Connectivity challenges Digital maturity Network operating environment	Position in value chain Commercial model Relationship to end customers
		
Archetype implication	Needs-based archetypes	Company-type archetypes

We have completed 6 wholesale interviews so far, with another 2 scheduled

No.	Role title	Company profile	Date	Status
1	Sales Director	Wholesaler	26/05/2026	Completed
2	Head of Commercial Sales	MSP	28/05/2026	Completed
3	Product Leader	Wholesaler	04/06/2026	Completed
4	Senior Product Manager	Carrier	04/06/2026	Completed
5	Commercial & Strategy Product Manager	Aggregator	05/06/2026	Completed
6	Head of Product	Carrier	09/06/2026	Completed
7	Account Manager	MSP	17/06/2026	Scheduled
8	Product Manager	Aggregator	18/06/2026	Scheduled

Key:  Completed  Upcoming

Wholesale archetypes have more in common than they have differences



Wholesalers want automation and visibility from upstream suppliers...

Automated lifecycle management

Reduce manual effort across quoting, provisioning, MACDs, fault handling and service management

Accurate delivery visibility

Provide reliable timelines and transparent order tracking – reliable delivery more important than fast delivery

Standardised API integration

Work towards consistent APIs (TM Forum), connecting supplier capabilities into internal portals and workflows

Operational control and transparency

Provide visibility of network performance, usage and service status across fragmented supplier estates

Commercial and billing visibility

Provide clearer charging, consumption and billing information to reduce reconciliation effort and customer disputes

They also broadly aligned in the outcomes they seek to deliver downstream



...so that they can deliver simplicity, predictability and reliability to downstream customers

Meet promised timelines

Provide customers with realistic expectations and proactive updates (KCIIs) throughout the service lifecycle

Provide a single pane of glass

Offer a unified view of services, orders, faults and performance regardless of underlying suppliers

Simplify service consumption

Allow customers to consume connectivity without dealing with upstream supplier complexity

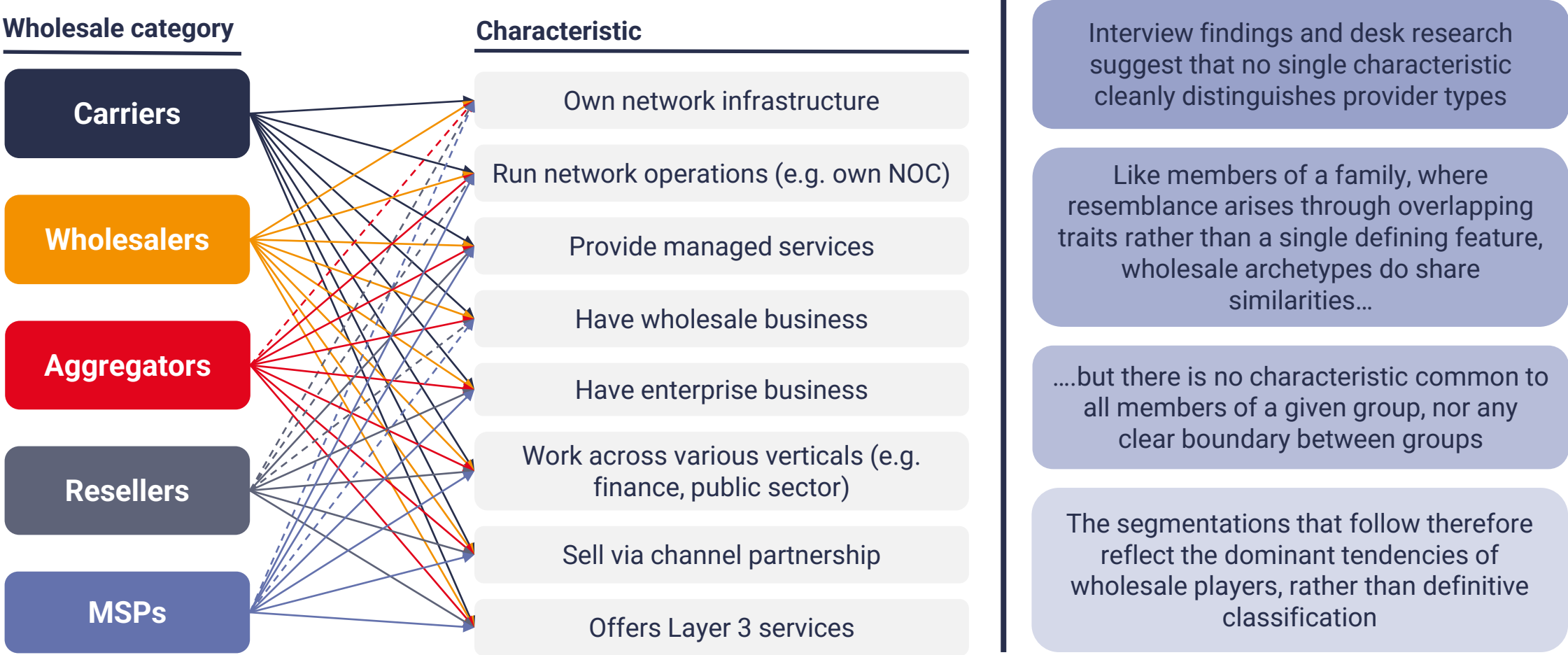
Consistent customer experience

Deliver the same operational experience across different networks, technologies and locations

Greater customer control

Enable faster changes, improved visibility and self-service capabilities while maintaining governance and clear audit trails

Unlike enterprise customers, no single set of characteristics cleanly separates wholesale customers into archetypes



BT's wholesale customers can be provisionally grouped into two archetypes based on their primary role in the connectivity ecosystem

	 Infrastructure-led	 Customer-led
Core role in the ecosystem	Own and operate fibre and transport infrastructure. Connectivity is their core business	Bring together services from multiple providers into a single customer proposition. Connectivity may be one component of their business
Primary value proposition	Create value through network reach, coverage and connectivity capability	Create value through customer relationships, solution design and commercial reach
Typical routes to market	Sell connectivity capabilities directly and through partners	Primarily bring connectivity capabilities to market through aggregation/managed solutions
Relationship with BT	Both compete with and buy from BT Wholesale; partial overlap with UK Fabric	Primarily customers of BT Wholesale, rather than direct competitors
Example company profiles	        	    

The fact the two archetypes create value in different ways shapes what they want from NaaS

To be refined in remaining interviews

	 Infrastructure-led	 Customer-led
Core business priority	Expand network reach and bring new connectivity products to market	Simplify connectivity for customers
Pain point most felt	Manual processes and fragmented systems slow service delivery and growth	Supplier friction slows quoting, provisioning, and customer communication
What they want most from NaaS	Programmable, modular connectivity building blocks that extend or complement their own network	A simple, governed buying and management experience across suppliers
Key NaaS priorities	• Modularity – want to combine products into differentiated connectivity propositions for customers • API-first control – want supplier capabilities exposed through APIs, enabling direct control over service configuration • Automated lifecycle management - prefer self-service and automation over manual account management	• Strong demand for single pane of glass – unified visibility across suppliers, services and contracts • Governance-first – value transparency, auditability and controlled self-service more than unrestricted configurability • Supplier simplification – reduce operational effort associated with managing multiple providers

The differing value drivers of each archetype are reflected in their NaaS capability priorities

Key:



Core value driver



Important but conditional / secondary



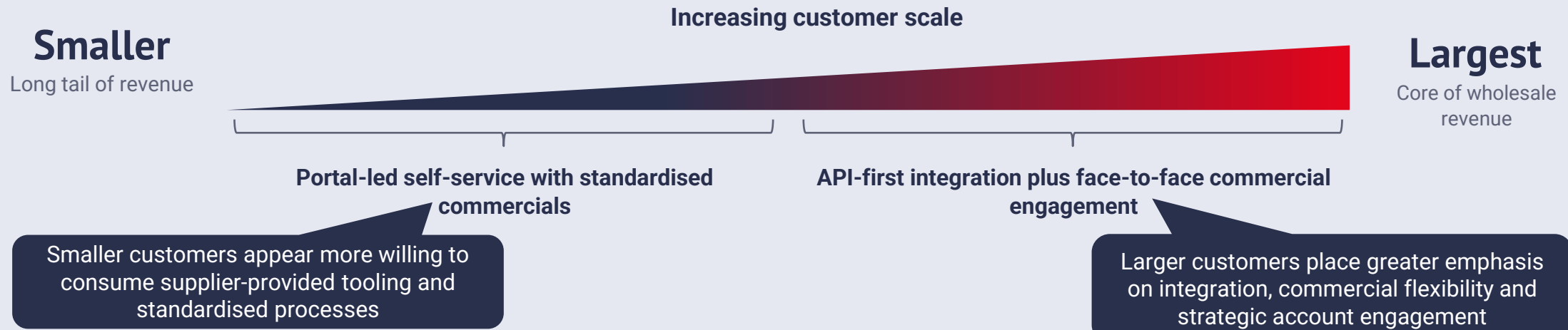
Hygiene requirement / not main buying trigger

To be refined

Attributes of NaaS	 Infrastructure-led	 Customer-led
Observable	Need visibility of network performance, utilisation and service status to support day-to-day operations	Need a single view across suppliers, services and orders to simplify customer management
Flexible	Generally secondary to programmability and automation; in some cases viewed as a structural threat to wholesale margins	Open to consumption-based and flexible commercial models, but indifferent as see limited evidence of customer demand today
Modular	View NaaS as a platform, with a desire to build differentiated propositions from modular components	Preference for integrated solutions and ability to package services, but not a core factor in assessing supplier
Manageable	Want self-service control and automation that can be embedded into their own products and passed on to customers	Strong desire to manage supplier services efficiently through portals, lifecycle management tools and self-service controls
On-Demand	A fundamental attraction of NaaS, enabling rapid provisioning, service changes and capacity adjustments across wide customer bases	Faster provisioning is attractive, but demand for dynamic bandwidth and frequent service changes appears limited
Programmable	Strong demand for APIs, automation and integration into operational systems, whether to improve efficiency or enable new propositions	Preference for API-enabled suppliers that support automated quoting, pricing integration and supplier consolidation
Secure	Rarely raised as a differentiator, whilst important, it's an assumed baseline requirement for any network	More prominent due to governance and customer trust considerations, particularly in managed environments

While archetypes help explain differing NaaS needs, customer scale may provide an additional lens for who BT should prioritise

Interview evidence suggests that customer size is another factor in how wholesale customers prefer to engage with suppliers



- As a small number of customers are likely to contribute a disproportionate share of wholesale revenues, BT may wish to prioritise their requirements when shaping its NaaS proposition
- Further validation would be required across a broader set of wholesale customers before drawing further links as to how customer scale and customer archetype might usefully intersect

Key takeaways and points for discussion

1

The wholesale ecosystem resists neat categorisation; archetypes should be understood in the context of resemblance rather than clear category difference

2

Despite significant overlap in requirements, Infrastructure-led providers prioritise programmability, modularity and automation, while Customer-led providers place greater emphasis on visibility and supplier simplification

3

Alongside archetype, customer scale may provide a useful prioritisation lens for BT, with larger customers placing greater emphasis on a combination of technical integration and face-to-face commercial engagement